

# U.P.S.C.

प्रश्न संख्या  
(Question No.)

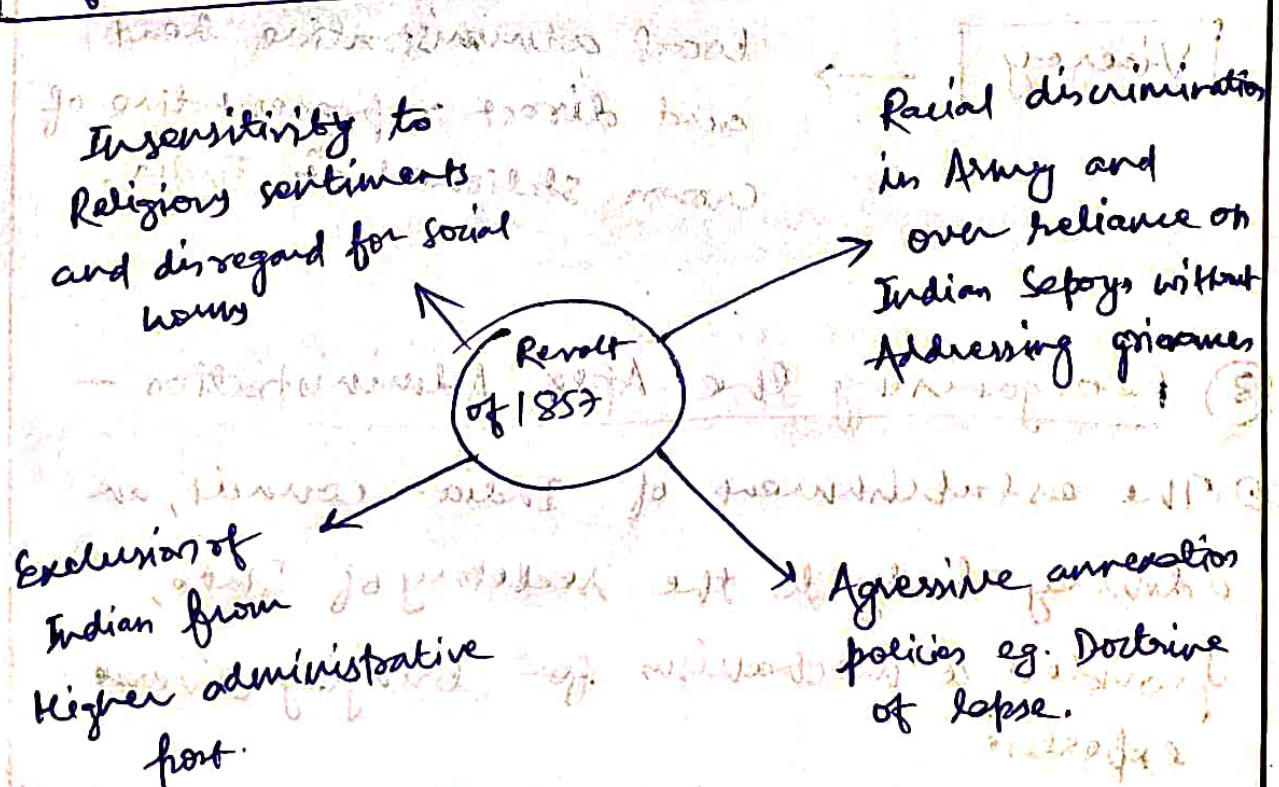
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DAY - 2

Q → Discuss how the Government of India Act of 1858 and 1861 reflect the British response of the revolt of 1857 - not just as a political crisis but as an administrative reckoning. (38M)

Ans The revolt of 1857 not only shook the foundation of British Governance but also exposed the administrative shortcomings. In response to this, Government of <sup>India</sup> Act (1858) and the Indian Council Act (1861) were brought to transform the administrative set-up in India.

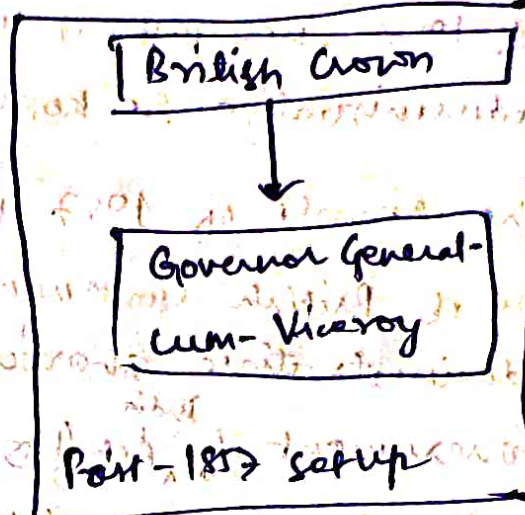
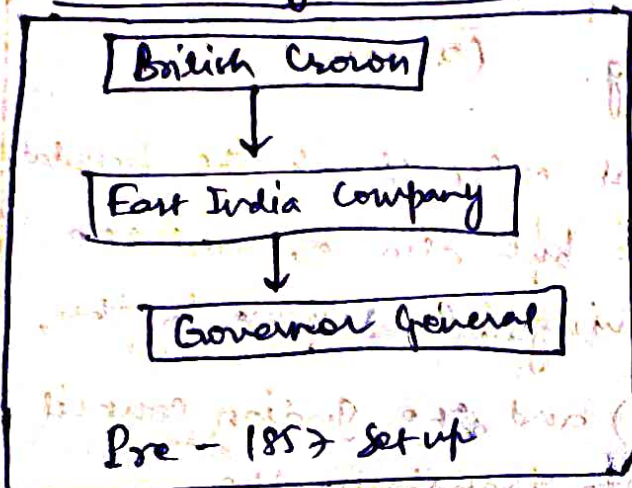
Administrative shortcomings exposed by Revolt of 1857





Acts of 1858 and 1861 : Tool for administrative reworking

## ① Centralizing control :-



## ② Establishing Clear line of Authority

**Secretary of State** → With his/her council, looking after Indian affairs stationed in London

**Viceroy** → Local administrative head and direct representative of Crown stationed <sup>in</sup> India.

## ③ Reorganising the Apex Administration -

① The establishment of India-council, an advisory body to the Secretary of State, provided a mechanism for bringing diverse expertise.

① later on, Indians like Krishna Gupta and



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Syed Hussain Bilgrami were firsts to be included in 1907 intended to inject informed Indian perspectives into Governance

## ④ Acknowledging Princely States -

① By ending the doctrine of lapse and reorganising the rights of princely states under British paramountcy, these acts signaled a shift in policy towards Indian rulers.

## ⑤ Decentralisation of <sup>Legislative</sup> Administrative powers -

① Restoration of legislative powers of presidencies of Bombay and Madras to make governance more responsible to local needs and conditions.

## ⑥ Formalizing the Portfolio System -

① Under this, each member was responsible for a specific department and this brought a degree of efficiency.

## ⑦ Empowering the viceroy -

① Granting the viceroy the power to



issue ordinances during emergencies provided the executive with greater flexibility to respond to crises.

## Limitations of Acts of 1858 and 1861

- ① Limited inclusion of Indians with no democratic principles - members nominated by Viceroy and that too as non-official members.
- ② Viceroy's overriding power and Secretary of State's Supremacy with responsibility to British parliament only.
- ③ Seeds of Divide and rule perpetuated as a tacit administrative strategy.
- ④ Failure to address fundamental grievances of Indian population.

The government of India Act (1858) brought fundamental change in British administrative machinery from inside while the Indian Council Act (1861) was intended to bring

Administrative changes in the wake of addressing the grievances of Indian population. Although some reforms were brought like nomination of Indian in council but there were intended to make an impression not to bring grass-root change.